

SecureDocs API Technical Guide

Version 1.0 - Backend integration reference for authentication, endpoints, rate limits, and error handling.

1. Authentication

SecureDocs API uses bearer token authentication. Every protected request must include an Authorization header in the format: Authorization: Bearer YOUR_ACCESS_TOKEN. Tokens expire after 60 minutes and should be refreshed using the /auth/refresh endpoint.

If the token is missing, expired, or invalid, the API returns HTTP 401 with the error code AUTH_INVALID_TOKEN.

2. Core Endpoints

Method	Endpoint	Purpose
POST	/documents	Upload a PDF document for processing.
GET	/documents/{document_id}	Fetch document metadata and processing status.
POST	/query	Ask a question against indexed technical documents.
DELETE	/documents/{document_id}	Delete a document and all vector chunks.

3. Rate Limits

The API allows 120 requests per minute per API key. When the limit is exceeded, the API returns HTTP 429 with the error code RATE_LIMIT_EXCEEDED. Clients should retry after the number of seconds provided in the Retry-After response header.

4. Error Handling

All error responses use JSON with fields: error_code, message, and request_id. The request_id should be logged by client applications and included when reporting issues to support.

Common errors include VALIDATION_ERROR for malformed JSON, DOCUMENT_NOT_FOUND for unknown document IDs, and UNSUPPORTED_FILE_TYPE when a non-PDF file is uploaded.

5. Security Recommendations

Store API tokens in environment variables or a secure secret manager. Never commit tokens to source control. Use HTTPS for all production traffic and rotate access tokens at least every 90 days.